

Avora — Product Blueprint

Product Specification v1.0

Built on: Life Engine Architecture (graph-based, lens-driven Engine + Brain) and Experience Architecture (non-gamified, memory-based Town). This document does not revisit those decisions — it scopes them into something buildable.

1. User Personas

1.1 Primary user — "The Overwhelmed Systematizer"

Someone managing a genuinely full life across many domains — work, health, home, relationships, money — who has tried multiple productivity systems (Notion, task apps, planners) and abandoned all of them. Not lazy, not disorganized in ability — disorganized in *tooling*. Often has attention/executive-function differences (ADHD or ADHD-adjacent) that make anything requiring sustained manual upkeep collapse within weeks.

Jobs to be done:

- "When something's on my mind, let me get it out of my head in under 5 seconds, without deciding what it is yet."
- "When I open the app, tell me the one thing that matters right now, not everything that's open."
- "Let me feel like my life is being held somewhere, without that place becoming another thing I have to maintain."
- "Show me, eventually, that effort added up to something — without making me chase a number to feel that."

Pain points:

- Existing tools require categorization *at the moment of capture*, which is exactly when they have the least bandwidth for it.
- Task lists that only grow become a source of guilt, not clarity — the visual of "47 open items" is itself the thing that causes avoidance.
- Gamified apps (streaks, XP) work for a few weeks, then the broken streak becomes a reason to quit entirely.

- Every abandoned tool represents a small, cumulative loss of trust in themselves ("I can't even keep this up").

1.2 Secondary user — "The Light-Touch Maintainer"

Someone without significant executive-function friction who simply wants a calmer, more meaningful alternative to juggling five single-purpose apps (calendar, notes, budgeting, habit tracker, journal). Lower emotional stakes, but the same core need: less fragmentation, less noise.

Jobs to be done:

- "Replace four apps with one, without losing what each one did well."
- "Let me see my life's shape over a year, not just today's to-do list."

1.3 Persona explicitly deferred (not designed for in v1)

Shared/family use (a household jointly maintaining a life graph, or a partner viewing a shared Town). Real need, real future value — out of scope until the single-user experience is proven. Designing for two users before one user is solid is how the Engine ends up compromised for both.

2. User Journeys

2.1 First launch

No feature tour. No 13-area setup wizard (that would recreate the exact overwhelm the product exists to remove). One screen: a single capture field and a short, warm line establishing what Avora is — "Tell me what's on your mind. I'll take it from here." First action is capture, not configuration. Areas and districts are discovered by using the product, not chosen from a menu on day one.

2.2 First capture

User types or speaks one thing. Immediate, local acknowledgment (no spinner, no "processing your request" — it just *lands*, the way saying something out loud to a person lands). Brain triage happens asynchronously, invisibly. Next time they look, it's already been filed — sitting where it belongs, with a light, undramatic note if the Brain wants a correction ("Filed under Work — let me know if that's wrong").

2.3 First week

Today surface starts genuinely ranking (needs a few data points to be useful, so early Today views stay deliberately sparse and honest rather than pretending confidence). First district appears on the skyline the first time something is completed. No push notification campaign; at most one optional, quiet daily digest, opt-in.

2.4 First month

Enough graph density for the Brain to make its first real cross-area connection ("this and this seem related") — this is the moment the product's core promise becomes tangible rather than theoretical. First landmark foundation appears if a goal has been set. First Reflect surface (light, optional, no report card).

2.5 First year

Town has visible seasons — a busy stretch, a quiet stretch, both intact and neither erased. A small number of real landmarks stand as permanent record. The user's relationship to the app has (by design) become intermittent and light — this is success, not disengagement.

3. MVP Scope (Version 1)

In scope

- **Universal Capture** (text + voice), always one tap away, works offline
- **Brain triage**: type/area classification, linking to existing items, confidence-scored, silent by default
- **Core graph**: tasks, notes, goals, projects, events, people, places — with typed links
- **Today surface**: Brain-ranked, capped list (not an "everything" view)
- **Calendar**: native view + two-way sync with one external calendar provider (Google Calendar first)
- **5 area lenses at launch**, chosen for breadth of daily relevance: Work, Health, Home, Relationships, Finance (as ambient/infrastructure layer per Experience Architecture, not a full feature set)
- **Goals & Projects**: creation, linking to tasks, progress inferred from linked activity
- **Notes**: freeform, linkable to anything
- **Town v1**: skyline view, districts for the 5 launch areas, landmark generation for completed goals, basic day/night + weather-light ambiance
- **Reflect**: simple weekly surface, opt-in, no streak logic
- **Search**: single global search across the graph

Deliberately excluded from v1

- Remaining 8 area lenses (Reading, Meal Planning, Pets, Travel, Projects-as-distinct-from-Goals nuance, etc.) — added post-launch once the core loop is validated
- Shared/family graphs and shared Town
- Deep financial integration (bank sync, budgeting logic) — Finance stays manual-entry only in v1
- Full seasonal/year-long Town narrative rendering — v1 ships ambient light/weather only, not multi-year "eras"
- Multiple calendar/account integrations beyond one provider
- Any notification system beyond a single optional daily digest
- Third-party import/migration tooling (Notion, Todoist, etc.)
- Voice-first/ambient/wearable interaction

Rationale: v1's only job is to prove the core loop — capture → invisible triage → ranked Today → occasional, honest Town growth — works emotionally, not just technically. Everything excluded either adds surface area before that loop is validated, or depends on scale/data Avora won't have on day one.

4. Screen Inventory

Screen	Purpose
First Launch	Single capture field; establishes tone, no setup wizard
Capture (global overlay)	Always-available entry point for voice/text capture, reachable from anywhere
Today	Brain-ranked daily surface; the default home screen
Area Switcher	Lightweight drawer/list to move between the 5 launch lenses
Area Lens (template)	Filtered view of the graph for one area — reused per area, not bespoke per area
Item Detail (generic)	Single template for viewing/editing any item type (task, note, event, goal)

Screen	Purpose
Goal Detail	Goal-specific view: linked projects/tasks, progress, associated landmark status
Project Detail	Project-specific view: linked tasks, timeline
Calendar	Native calendar view, merges synced + native events
Notes List / Note Detail	Freeform notes, linkable to any item
Town (skyline view)	Primary Town experience — districts, landmarks, ambiance
Landmark Detail	View a single landmark and the goal/memory behind it
Reflect	Weekly light-touch review surface
Search	Global graph search
Settings	Account, privacy controls, calendar connection, notification preference
Onboarding correction prompts (inline, not a screen)	Lightweight in-context confirmations when Brain confidence is low

Fifteen screens, most of them templates reused across areas rather than one-off builds — the screen count stays flat even as area lenses expand later, because the architecture (§1 of the Life Engine doc) makes areas configurations of shared screens, not new screens.

5. Functional Requirements

Feature	Description	User Benefit	Dependencies	Priority
Universal Capture	Single input (text/voice) with zero required categorization at entry	Removes the #1 abandonment cause: friction at capture	Local storage, async queue	P0

Feature	Description	User Benefit	Dependencies	Priority
Brain Triage	Classifies capture into type/area, links related items, confidence-scored	Delivers "invisible filing," the core value prop	Core graph, capture pipeline	P0
Core Graph Engine	Typed items + typed edges, per Life Engine data model	Foundation for all cross-area intelligence	—	P0
Today Ranking	Ranks a capped set of items by due proximity, inferred energy fit, goal alignment	Delivers "reduces overwhelm" as an actual mechanism, not a slogan	Graph engine, Brain triage	P0
Area Lenses (5)	Filtered views into the graph per launch area	Lets users think in life-domain terms without separate apps	Graph engine	P0
Calendar Sync (1 provider)	Two-way sync with Google Calendar	Removes the need for a separate calendar app	External API	P0
Goal → Landmark Mapping	Completed/in-progress goals render as growing/finished Town structures	Delivers the emotional payoff described in the Experience Architecture	Graph engine, Town renderer	P0
Town Renderer	Renders districts, landmarks, ambient light/weather	Makes progress visible without gamification	Goal→Landmark mapping	P0

Feature	Description	User Benefit	Dependencies	Priority
Reflect (weekly)	Optional light review of the past week's activity	Supports meaning-making without turning into a report card	Graph engine	P1
Global Search	Search across all items	Findability as graph grows	Graph engine	P1
Offline Capture Queue	Captures work with no connection, sync on reconnect	Non-negotiable for a "get it out of my head instantly" promise	Local storage	P0
Confidence-based correction prompts	Inline, low-friction correction when Brain isn't confident	Preserves trust without adding capture-time friction	Brain triage	P1
Daily digest (opt-in)	One optional daily notification	Respects "never manipulates attention" constraint	Notification service	P2

6. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance Capture must acknowledge in under 150ms regardless of network state — this is the single hardest performance requirement in the product, because capture-time friction is the primary failure mode being designed against. Today surface should render from cache instantly, then reconcile with fresh Brain ranking in the background.

Privacy User's life graph is not used for advertising or sold/shared with third parties under any circumstance — this is foundational to the "companion, not tool" trust relationship. Clear, plain-language data export and full-account deletion available at all times. No dark patterns around data retention.

Offline behavior Capture must always work fully offline. Today, Area lenses, and Town should work in a read/cached mode offline; Brain triage and Town updates sync when connectivity returns. The user should never be blocked from getting a thought out of their head by a network state.

Accessibility Full screen-reader support across all screens including Town (Town needs a non-visual equivalent — e.g., a narrated summary of districts/landmarks — so the experience isn't visual-only). No information conveyed by color alone (relevant for Town's ambient states — rest vs. neglect must be distinguishable without color dependence). Standard WCAG AA target across the app.

Security Encryption in transit and at rest. Standard modern auth (passkey/OAuth preferred over password-only). No local caching of sensitive graph data in plaintext on device beyond what's needed for offline function.

AI latency Brain triage should complete within a few seconds in the common case but must never block the capture flow — capture succeeds instantly regardless of triage speed. Today's ranking should feel "already there" on open; if a fresh Brain computation is slow, show best-available cached ranking rather than a loading state, consistent with never manipulating attention through waiting.

7. Future Roadmap

Version 2

- Remaining 8 area lenses (Reading, Meal Planning, Pets, Travel, and the rest)
- Multi-year Town narrative rendering — visible "eras," not just current ambiance
- Manual-entry Finance evolves into optional read-only bank linking (categorization only, no budgeting logic added — stays true to "infrastructure, not a district")
- Additional calendar/account providers
- Richer Reflect (monthly, alongside weekly)

Version 3

- Shared/family graphs and shared Town — the deferred secondary persona from §1.3, now built on a proven single-user core
- Voice-first / ambient interaction modes
- Deeper cross-area Brain insight (e.g., long-horizon pattern surfacing across years, not just weeks)

Long-term vision

Avora as an ambient life companion that a person carries across every device without friction — the graph as the permanent record of a life, the Town as its visual memory, and the Brain quiet enough that most days, using it well means barely opening it at all.